	DISTRIBUTION AND CUSTOMER SUPPORT PROCEDURE	
	Document no: **ASMF-7.15 PROCEDURE**	
	Compiled by:	**Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager**
	Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**

Contents

Purpose 2

Application 2

Responsibilities 2

Procedure 2

Records 3

Revision 4

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Purpose

To define the process for the packaging, shipment, documentation and post-distribution support of proficiency testing samples and coal reference materials in accordance with ISO 17043:2023 (clause 7.3.4) ISO 17034:2016 (Clause 7.15)

Application

This procedure applies to all PT samples and batches of coal reference materials packaged and distributed by the organization.

Responsibilities

Laboratory Manager/Supervisor: Ensures the correct packaging and distribution of PT samples and reference materials.

Laboratory Technician: Packages the reference materials.

Operations Manager: Maintains distribution records and ensures support and notifications are provided.

Procedure

Packaging and Distribution

Proficiency Testing Samples and Reference materials shall be packaged to prevent moisture ingress, contamination, direct sunlight and degradation.

- This can be achieved by packaging in seal proofed containers, packed inside a cardboard box with minimal free space inside to avoid breakages, sealed with a seal proof inserted or adequate packing material provided by courier services (eg. Plastic sleeve).
- The dispatching box are supposed to be accompanied by following:
  - Certificate of analysis
  - Product information sheet
  - Custom documentation (for international orders)

Shipping and Documentation

- Courier service providers must be chosen in the sense that they are able to provide tracking capabilities and a shorter time frame (defined as < or = 4 days) to deliver to clients.
- When using inhouse transportation and distribution, clients have to be notified of the date of delivery, and it is mandatory for the organization to keep to the agreed date.
- Shipping outside South Africa must include documentation required for customs clearance.

Notification of Changes

Any changes or revisions of assigned values or uncertainties happening within the validity period shall warrant the organization to notify the affected customers via email and a revised certificate of analysis shall be issued. Notification of such issues shall be kept for traceability purposes.

Records

Records must be kept for traceability purposes and produced in audits and management reviews when prompted to. The records are as follows but not limited to:

- Distribution Log
- Sales invoices
- Courier tracking records
- Customer support emails
- Notification letters or emails

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